

THE MANAGEMENT CYCLE

GODAE

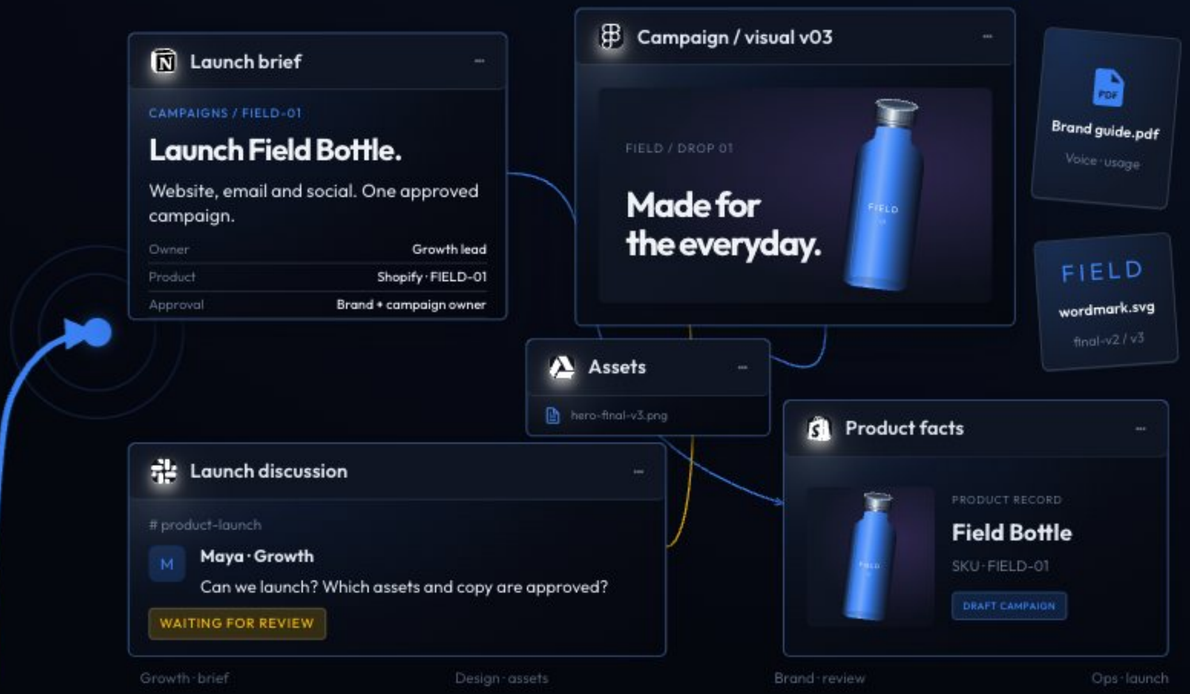
Managing AI transformation.

A practical framework for improving work inside organizations.

THE MANAGEMENT CYCLE
GODAE

AI makes building easier. Improving work still needs direction.

One product campaign. Briefs, brand PDFs, SVGs, facts and approvals scatter across tools.



THE MANAGEMENT CYCLE

GODAE

Manage the change through *five decisions*.

GODAE is the management cycle: Goal, Observe, Decide, Act and Evaluate. Begin with the end in mind.

GODAE / MANAGEMENT CYCLE

Five decisions. Clear handoffs.

Manage a change to one workflow, from business intent to measured results.

Goal	What must improve?	Analyst + Owner / outcome + behavior + targets
Observe	How does it work today?	Analyst / workflow + acceptance brief
Decide	What should change?	Developer / workflow + test and eval architecture
Act	Can we prove it works?	Developer / both harnesses + controlled pilot
Evaluate	Did it improve the work?	Analyst + Owner / acceptance + value + next decision

Each step produces the input for the next. Evaluation closes the loop.

THE MANAGEMENT CYCLE

GODAE

GODAE keeps transformation accountable.

Define success first. Carry the same requirements through design, tests, the pilot and its results.



GODAE · STEP 1 OF 5

GOAL

Set the Goal.

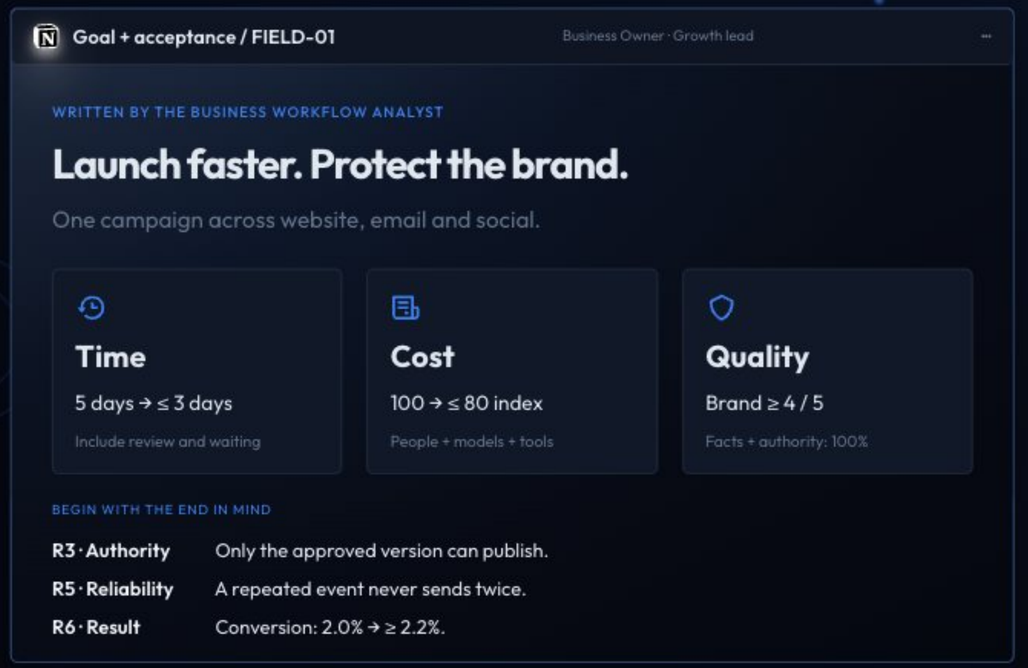
Business Workflow Analyst + Business Owner: define the result and the behavior that success requires.

GODAE · STEP 1 OF 5

GOAL

What are we actually trying to improve?

The Business Workflow Analyst writes the outcome and required behavior. The Business Owner agrees targets and owns the result.



GODAE · STEP 2 OF 5

OBSERVE

Observe the work.

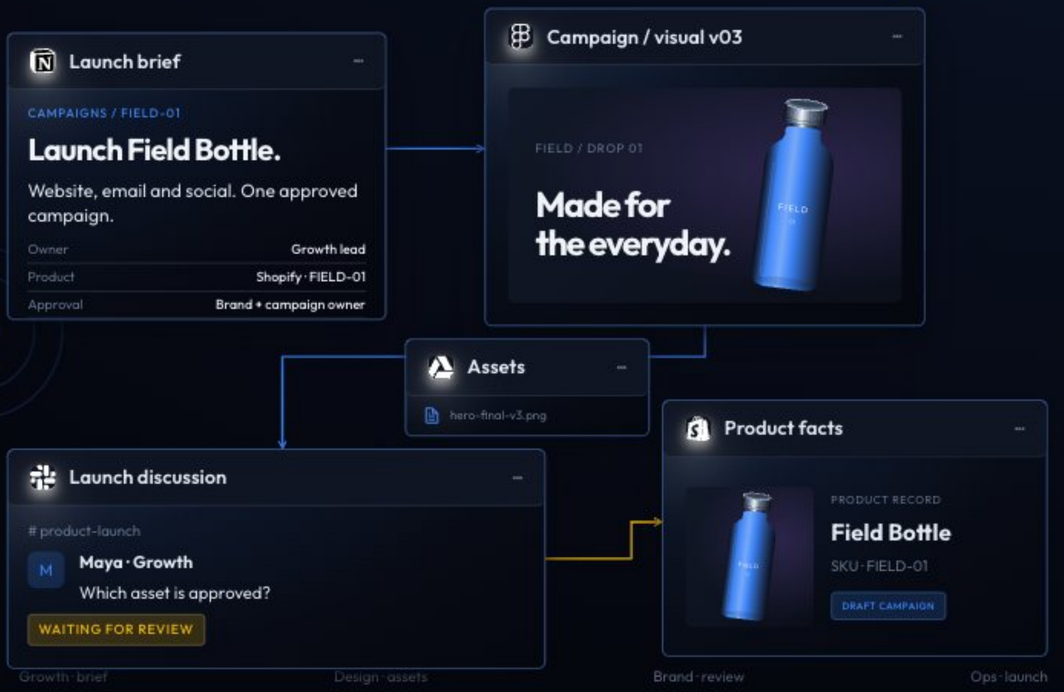
Business Workflow Analyst: document today's work and write its acceptance examples.

GODAE · STEP 2 OF 5

OBSERVE

Go see how work actually happens.

The Workflow Analyst follows the campaign: steps, UX, tools, permissions, owners and failure cases.



GODAE · STEP 2 OF 5

OBSERVE

SYSTEM + TOOLS + PEOPLE

Every workflow has three elements.

System is the logic. Tools carry out the work.
People own decisions and exceptions.
Describe success and failure inside each.

OBSERVE / A LENS FOR ANY WORKFLOW

Break down how the work happens.

01	**System**	**The logic of the work** — Inputs, steps, decisions, outputs and exceptions.
02	**Tools**	**The means of doing it** — Software, data, integrations and manual instruments.
03	**People**	**The ownership around it** — Who performs, decides, approves and handles exceptions.

Start from the Goal. Use this lens to describe today's work before redesigning it.

GODAE · STEP 2 OF 5

OBSERVE

SYSTEM + TOOLS + PEOPLE → ACCEPTANCE BRIEF

Write the workflow and its acceptance brief.

The Analyst records the Goal, current workflow, expected behavior and scoring examples. This is the input to both harnesses.

01
System
Brief → assets → copy → review → launch

02
Tools
Notion · Figma / Drive · Shopify · Slack

03
People
Growth writes. Design creates. Brand approves. Ops launches.

workflow-acceptance.md — Analyst · acceptance brief

FIELD-01 / WORKFLOW + ACCEPTANCE

The work + what success means.

Brief → Assets → Copy → Review → Launch

Goal	≤ 3 days · cost ≤ 80 · brand ≥ 4/5
Steps + UX	Draft → review exact version → publish all channels
Permissions	R1: scoped facts · R3: Brand owner approves
Behavior tests	R5: repeated trigger → no second send; failure → owner
Quality evals	R2: brand rubric + scored examples; R4: channel fit

TIME	COST	QUALITY
5 days → ≤ 3 days	100 → ≤ 80 index	Cases + rubric + owners

GODAE · STEP 3 OF 5

DECIDE

Decide what changes.

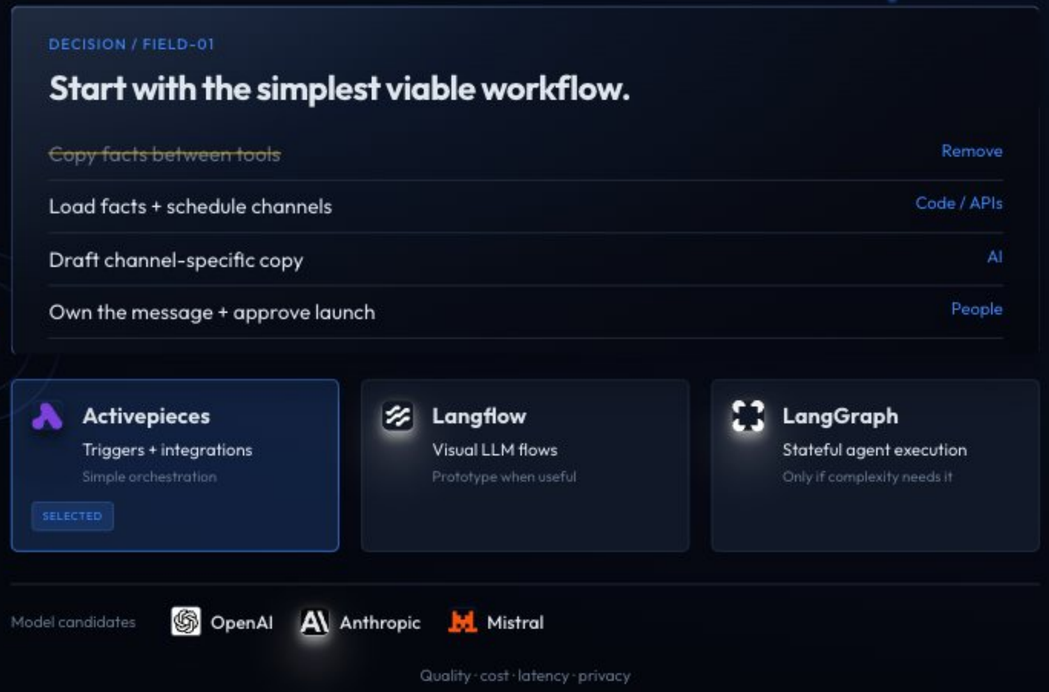
Workflow / Agent Developer: design the workflow and the tests and evals that prove it.

GODAE · STEP 3 OF 5

DECIDE

How could this work better?

The Workflow / Agent Developer removes waste, assigns work to people, code or AI, and uses acceptance examples to compare designs.



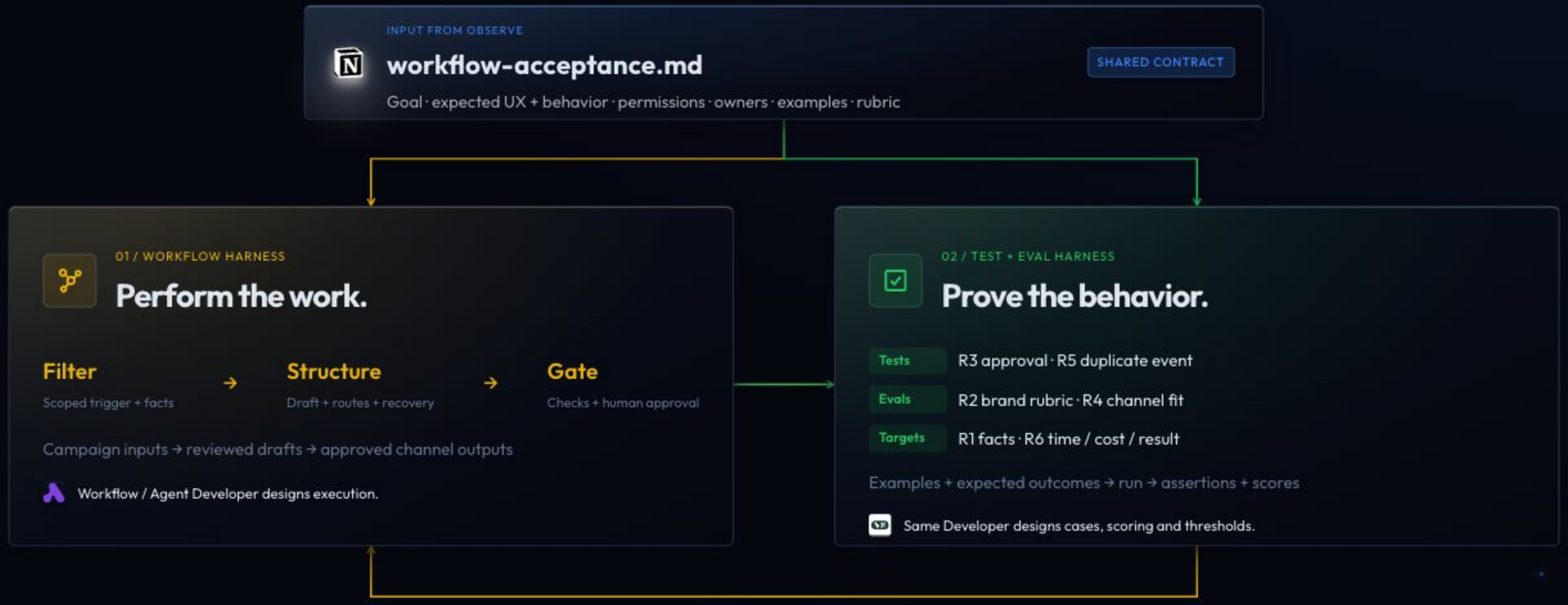
GODAE · STEP 3 OF 5

DECIDE

WORKFLOW HARNESS + TEST / EVAL HARNESS

Inside Decide: design two connected harnesses.

The workflow performs the task. The test and eval harness proves its behavior and quality against the same brief.



Failures and scores feed back into the workflow design.

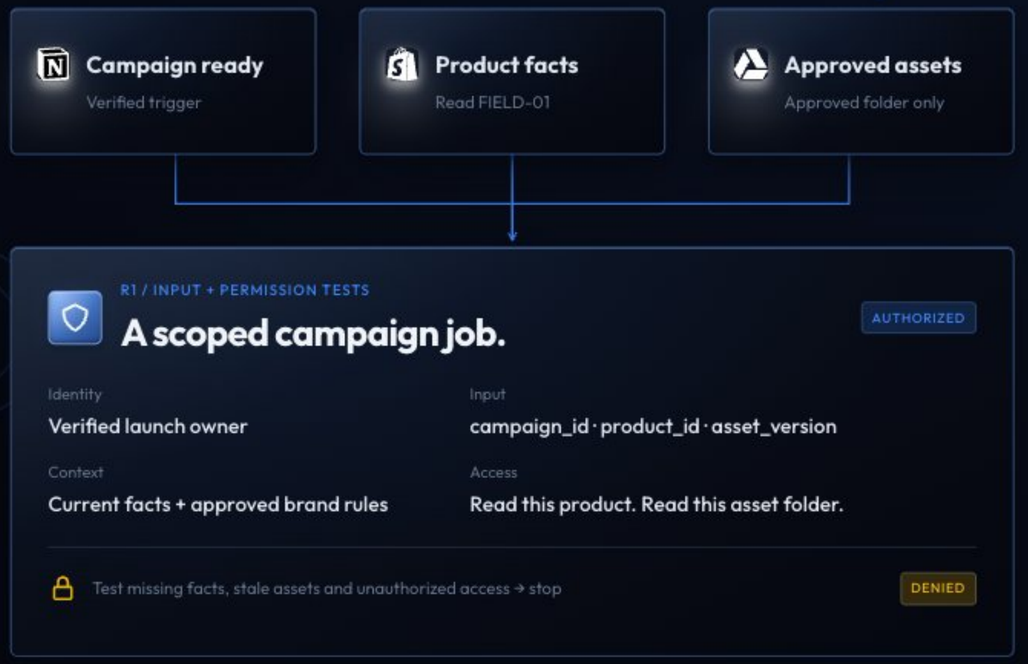
GODAE · STEP 3 OF 5

DECIDE

WORKFLOW + TESTS / FILTER

Filter: what comes in?

Design valid triggers, trusted context and permitted access. Write tests for missing, stale and unauthorized input.



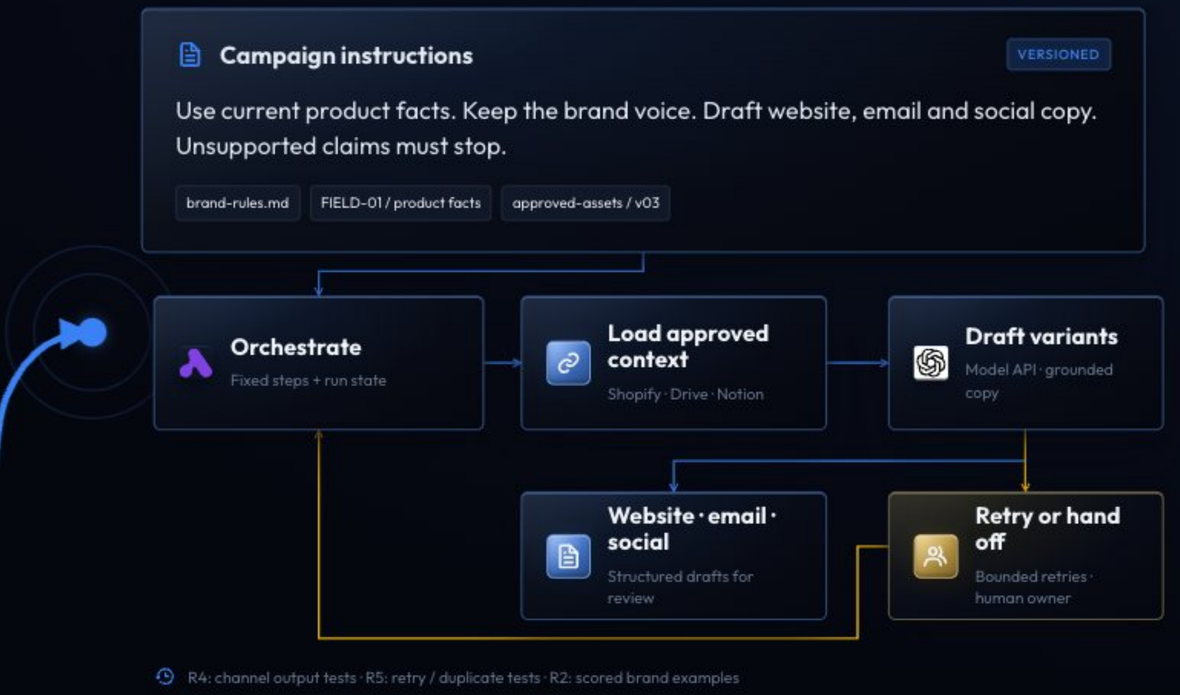
GODAE · STEP 3 OF 5

DECIDE

WORKFLOW + TESTS / STRUCTURE

Structure: how does the work get done?

Design steps, models, tools, UX, state and recovery. Pair each expected behavior with a test or scored example.



GODAE · STEP 3 OF 5

DECIDE

TESTS + EVALS + HUMAN APPROVAL

Gate: what must pass?

Tests verify exact behavior. Evals score quality. Required human approval checks authority before publication.

Behavior tests + Quality evals + Human authority

Release acceptance / FIELD-01 — DESIGN BEFORE BUILD

REQUIREMENT	CHECK	ACCEPT WHEN
R1 · Facts	Source + access test	100% supported / permitted
R2 · Brand	Rubric-based eval	≥ 4 / 5; no unsupported claims
R3 · Authority	Version / permission test	Exact version approved by owner
R5 · Repeats	Duplicate-event test	No second write or send

Passing checks does not grant approval. Brand owner still authorizes publication.

Failed check → hold + revise

Checks + approval → publish

GODAE · STEP 3 OF 5

DECIDE

PAIRED HARNESSES / ACCEPTANCE MAPPING

One design. Every requirement accounted for.

The Developer hands off both harnesses: execution architecture and the cases, rubrics and thresholds used to accept it.

Filter

R1 / TRUSTED INPUT

- Approved campaign brief
- Product read / FIELD-01
- Approved asset folder

SCOPED + AUTHENTICATED

Missing or unauthorized input stops here.

Structure

CAMPAIGN.RUN

R2 / Brand instructions · Facts + assets · Run state

Draft channel variants
Structured output · source-linked claims

Check facts + brand
R2 + R4 / rubric scores; failed output returns

Human approval
R3 / exact campaign + content version

R5 / bounded retry · no duplicate launch · reconcile failures

Gate

R3 / APPROVAL BEFORE WRITE

HOLD UNTIL APPROVED

Website
Approved product-page update

Email
Approved campaign + audience

Social
Approved assets + schedule

R6 / goal + time + cost + result saved

R1 Facts → Filter · R2 Brand → Context + evals · R3 Review → Approval gate · R4 Channels → Routes · R5 Failure → Recovery · R6 Results → Evidence

GODAE · STEP 4 OF 5

ACT

Act on the design.

Workflow / Agent Developer: implement both harnesses, then run a controlled pilot.

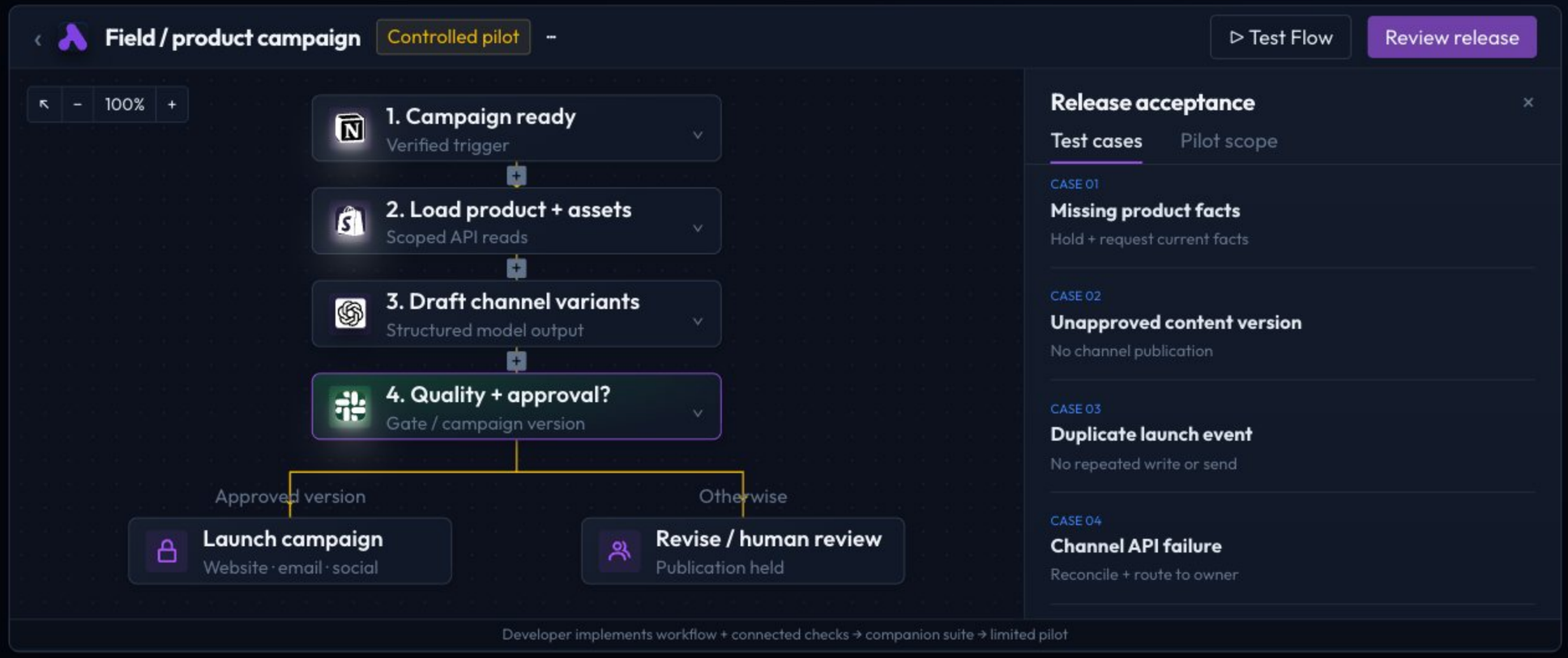
GODAE · STEP 4 OF 5

ACT

IMPLEMENTATION / WORKFLOW HARNESS

Build the workflow. Connect its checks.

The Developer implements the controlled workflow, with tests and evals at its boundaries. Activepieces is one implementation option.



GODAE · STEP 4 OF 5

ACT

IMPLEMENTATION / TEST + EVAL HARNESS

Build the tests and evals that prove it.

Implement the companion suite from the acceptance brief. Run it before the pilot and again whenever behavior changes.

FIELD-01 / acceptance suite — Developer · versioned with workflow

TEST + EVAL HARNESS / FROM workflow-acceptance.md

Examples become executable checks.

Same input. Expected behavior. A repeatable score.

CASE	INPUT / ACTION	EXPECTED / SCORING	TYPE
R1	Missing product facts	Stop; request current facts	Test
R3	Publish unapproved v04	No write or send permitted	Test
R5	Replay launch event	One campaign; zero repeat sends	Test
R2 / R4	Draft three channel variants	Brand + channel rubric ≥ 4 / 5	Eval

Save fixture, workflow version, result and score for every run.

Prove. Pilot. Repeat.

Before release

Run tests + evals. Fix misses. Keep required human approval.

In the pilot

Trace real runs. Score samples. Measure R6 business results.

After a change

Rerun the same suite. Catch regressions before widening scope.

WORKFLOW + SUITE SHIP TOGETHER

GODAE · STEP 5 OF 5

Evaluate the result.

Analyst + Business Owner: review behavior, business value and adoption against the Goal.

GODAE · STEP 5 OF 5

EVALUATE

BEHAVIOR + QUALITY

Did the workflow behave as required?

Analyst + Business Owner review traces, behavior tests and scored quality against the acceptance brief.

LangSmith SpielOS / Monitoring / **FIELD-01 / acceptance review**

ILLUSTRATIVE REPORT · NOT LIVE ACCOUNT DATA

Overview | Experiments | Runs | Feedback | Settings — Monthly review

Search experiments… | Filters | Group by workflow | ↻ Refresh

BEHAVIOR TESTS	FACTUAL ACCURACY	BRAND + CHANNEL FIT	TASK COMPLETION
4 / 4	100%	4.4 / 5	94%
Input · approval · replay · recovery	R1 / Goal: 100%	R2 / Goal: ≥ 4 / 5	R4 / Goal: ≥ 95% · missed

RUN / field-01.v03 — Load facts → Draft variants → Tests + evals → Owner approves v03 → Publish once

REQUIREMENT	CASE / RUBRIC	TYPE	TARGET	BASELINE	PILOT
R1 · Facts	Every claim has a source; missing facts stop	Test + eval	100%	96%	100%
R2 · Brand + channel fit	1 unusable · 3 needs edits · 5 ready	1–5 eval	≥ 4	3.6	4.4
R3 · Authority	Unapproved version produces no publication	Test	100%	100%	100%
R5 · Reliability	Repeated event: zero duplicate sends	Test	0 repeats	—	0
R4 · Completion	All three channels complete correctly	Test	≥ 95%	86%	94%

Analyst + Business Owner: hold expansion; fix completion and rerun the same acceptance suite.

ILLUSTRATIVE RUN + SCORED EXAMPLES

GODAE · STEP 5 OF 5

EVALUATE

RESULTS + USAGE + COST + ROI

Did it improve the business Goal?

Compare results, tokens and full cost with the baseline and targets. Report verified value and ROI together.

LangSmith SpielOS / Monitoring / **business-goals / cost / ROI**

ILLUSTRATIVE REPORT · NOT LIVE ACCOUNT DATA

Overview | Monitor | Runs | Feedback | Settings

Monthly review

Search workflows... | Filters | Group by workflow | Refresh

VERIFIED VALUE / FULL COST	ROI	TOKENS / MODEL SPEND	MODEL COST / SUCCESS
$3,600 / $2,400	50%	2.4M / $120	$0.097
Net value: $1,200	Goal: ≥ 60% · missed	2.0M input + 0.4M output	1,240 successful / 1,280 runs

MEASURE	BASELINE / COST BASIS	GOAL	ACTUAL	DECISION
Campaign time / cost	5 days / cost index 100	≤ 3 days / ≤ 80	3 days / 78	Met
Business result	2.0% conversion	≥ 2.2%	2.1%	Improve
Usage + model spend	Includes failed runs, retries and eval calls	≤ 3M / ≤ $150	2.4M / $120	Within budget
Full monthly cost	Model $120 + tools $180 + build $1,400 + people $700	≤ $2,500	$2,400	Within budget
Verified value / ROI	Cash saved $900 + contribution $2,700	ROI ≥ 60%	$3,600 / 50%	Improve
Capacity released	Keep separate from cash savings	Track separately	120 hours	Redeploy

ROI = (verified value − full cost) ÷ full cost. Same period / cohort. Analyst + Business Owner: improve before scaling.

SOURCE: FINANCE + GOAL REGISTER + RUNS

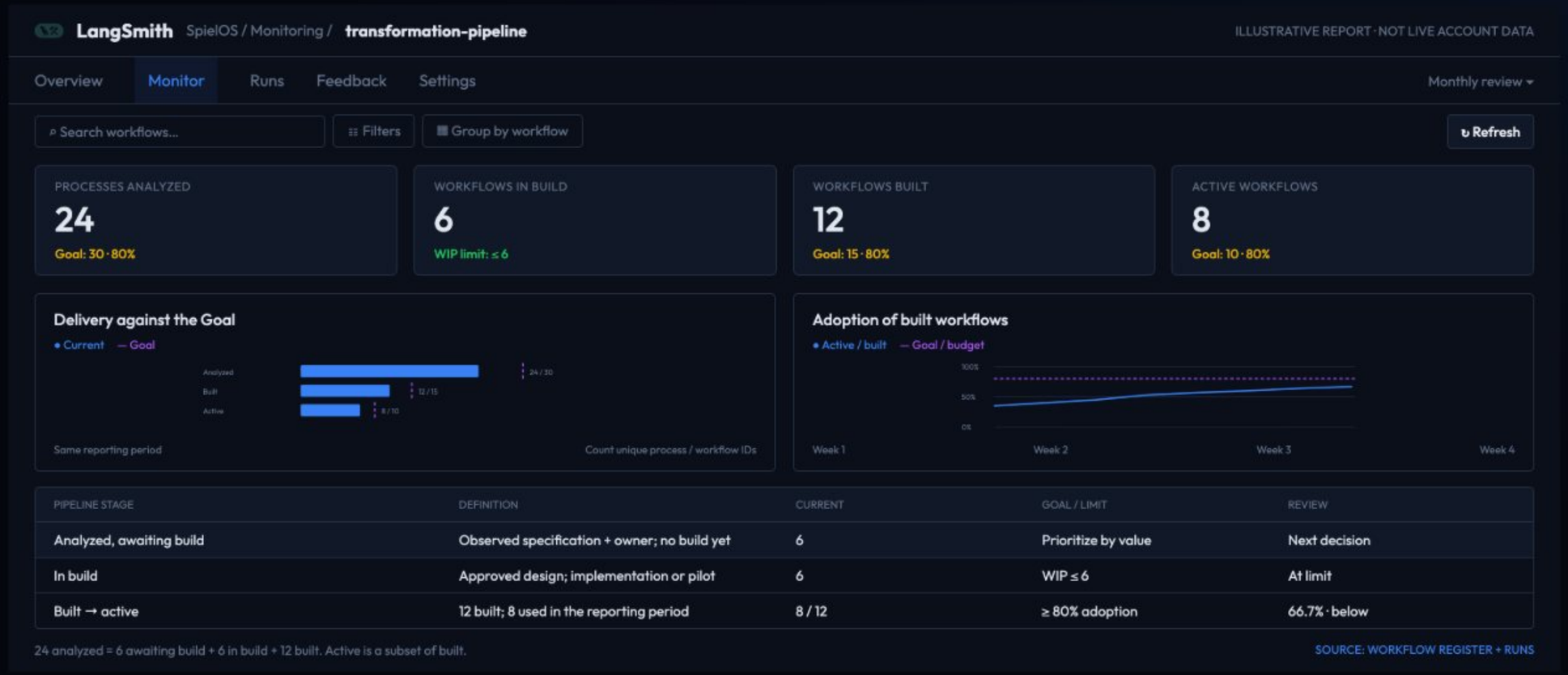
GODAE · STEP 5 OF 5

EVALUATE

PIPELINE + ADOPTION

Is transformation reaching real use?

Count analyzed processes, workflows in build, built and active. Review adoption against the Goal, then fix, stop, improve or scale.



PIPELINE STAGE	DEFINITION	CURRENT	GOAL / LIMIT	REVIEW
Analyzed, awaiting build	Observed specification + owner; no build yet	6	Prioritize by value	Next decision
In build	Approved design; implementation or pilot	6	WIP ≤ 6	At limit
Built → active	12 built; 8 used in the reporting period	8 / 12	≥ 80% adoption	66.7% · below

24 analyzed = 6 awaiting build + 6 in build + 12 built. Active is a subset of built.

SOURCE: WORKFLOW REGISTER + RUNS

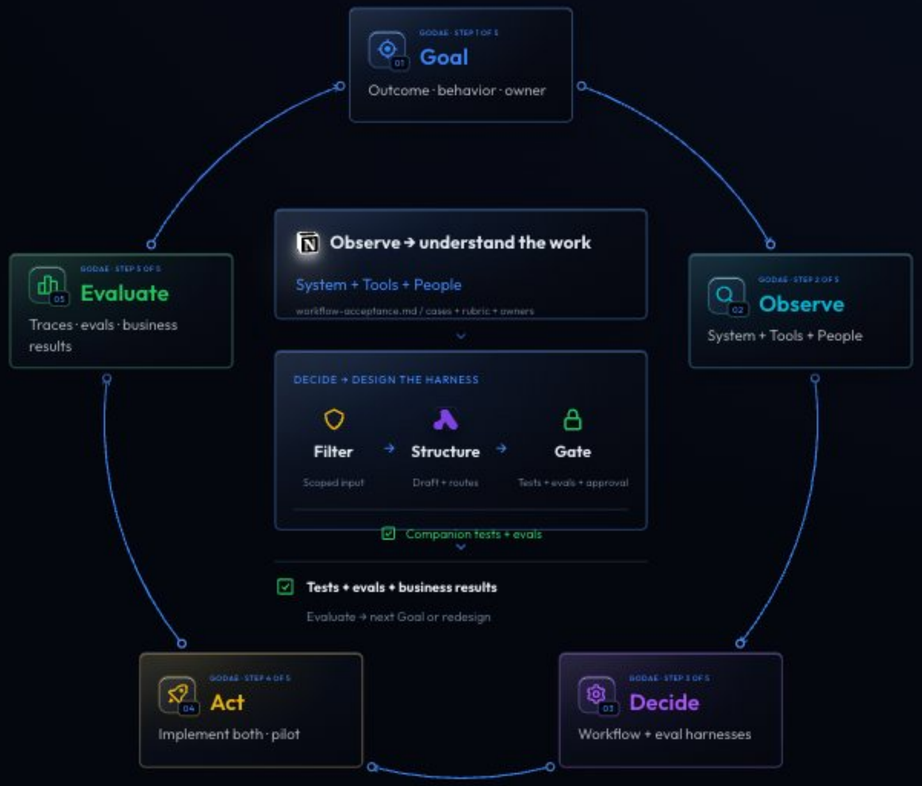
THE MANAGEMENT CYCLE

GODAE

COMPLETE MENTAL MODEL

Three models. One process for transformation.

GODAE manages the change. Observe describes the work. Decide designs both harnesses. Acceptance criteria connect every step.





THE MANAGEMENT CYCLE

GODAE

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Start with one workflow. Earn the right to scale.

One Analyst, one Developer and one accountable Business Owner. One person may hold several roles. Scale the evidence of improvement.

First transformation / campaign launch

YOUR FIRST CYCLE

Choose the work. Own the outcome.

Goal	Analyst + Owner: agree outcomes, behavior and targets.
Observe	Analyst: write workflow, acceptance examples and baseline.
Decide	Developer: simplify; design workflow + test / eval harnesses.
Act	Developer: implement both; pass checks; run a small pilot.
Evaluate	Analyst + Owner: compare acceptance, value and adoption.

Scale a proven improvement, then start the next cycle.

EXPERIMENT + LEARN

SIDE QUESTS

Side Quests.

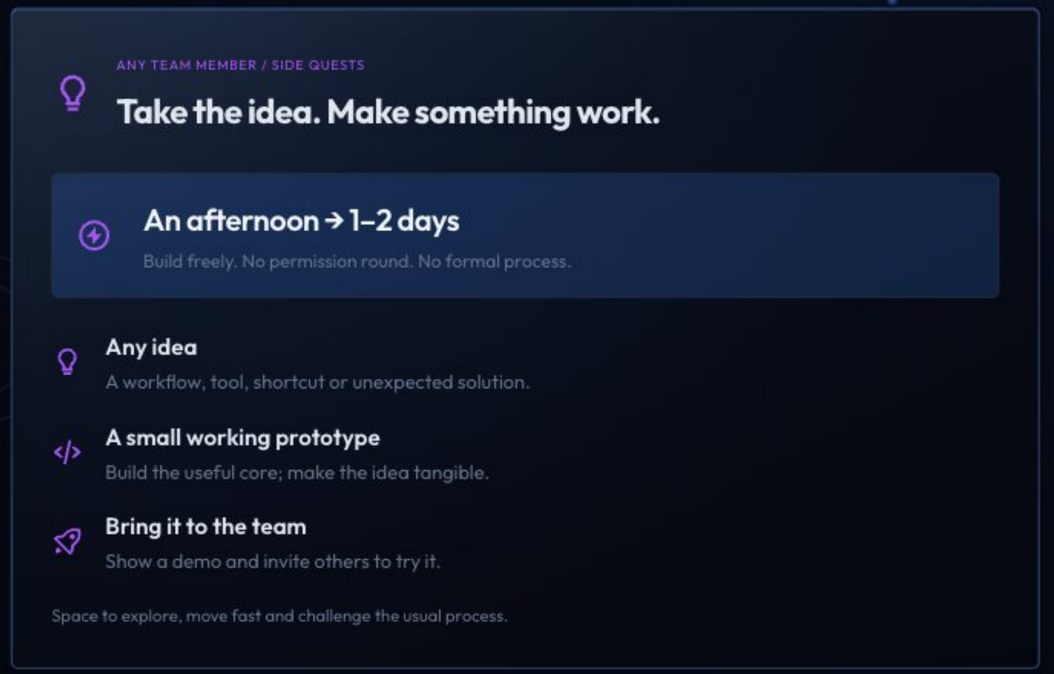
Make room to go off-track. Anyone on the team can build and try a new idea.

EXPERIMENT + LEARN

SIDE QUESTS

An idea. An *afternoon*. A working prototype.

Any team member can build an idea, workflow or solution without a permission round or the formal process. An afternoon to one or two days.



EXPERIMENT + LEARN

SIDE QUESTS

Try it together. Learn from real use.

Test with teammates, then in a real situation. Keep what helps, change what does not, and let discoveries challenge how the team works.





Thank you for your time.